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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

20482

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of NSC Principals Committee

DATE: May 6, 1993
LOCATION: White House Situation Room
TIME: 1:30 - 2:30pm

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

The Vice President's Office:
Leon Fuerth

State:
Clifton Wharton
Peter Tarnoff

USUN
Rick Inderfurth

DOD
Les Aspin
Frank Wisner

White House
Anthony Lake
Sandy Berger

CIA
James Woolsey
Gene Wicklund

NSC
Jane Holl

JCS
Colin Powell
Michael Ryan

Summary of Conclusions

Review of Current Situation

Principals agreed on the following:

Review of Current Situation

- U.S. has been following two tracks: the "Christopher" track and the Vance/Owen negotiation track. The Christopher Track has reinforced the Vance/Owen track.
~~(S)~~
- With the vote in Pale, focus must now shift back to the Christopher track. ~~(S)~~
- We will not let the referendum be used as a delaying device. ~~(S)~~

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- The course Secretary Christopher is presenting to allies is the only coherent and workable strategy on the table. It represents a set of measures designed to come to grips with the situation in Bosnia. ~~(S)~~
- The ball is now in the Europeans' court, and our task is to pressure them into action. ~~(S)~~

Eastern Bosnia/Safe Havens

Principals agreed that the U.S. should not offer U.S. ground troops to secure safe havens since that was not a militarily tenable mission. ~~(S)~~

They were divided on the extent to which we would consider the use of U.S. air power. ~~(S)~~

- Lake, Powell, Aspin, Berger, and Woolsey agreed that, in addition to the plan being presented by Christopher, we must be prepared to contemplate use of air power in Eastern Bosnia in support of the establishment of additional safe havens, assuming that UNPROFOR forces were willing and able to gain access to other enclaves in Eastern Bosnia (as an extension of our existing bilateral commitments to protect UNPROFOR forces already in Bosnia). ~~(S)~~
- Tarnoff argued not only for the use of air power to protect/defend UNPROFOR, both against category I and category II targets, but also to consider air power as punishment against category II targets -- decoupled from the arms embargo. ~~(S)~~

Contingencies

Lake summarized options for Principals to consider as next steps if the Europeans completely reject the strategy being presented by Christopher:

- Unilateral military action by the United States. ~~(S)~~
- Leave the Europeans to handle the crisis alone. ~~(S)~~
- Adopt one of the various European approaches (i.e., air strikes, blockade, etc.). ~~(S)~~
- Continue the present course (i.e., embargo plus diplomacy). ~~(S)~~
- Develop a strategy based upon containing the conflict to Bosnia (i.e., preventing spread to Kosovo). ~~(S)~~
- Undertake a campaign of air strikes for the explicit purpose of punishment. ~~(S)~~
- Pursue a cease-fire, enforced by the UN. ~~(S)~~

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